PLAYER TOOLKIT / 04

MONEY OVERSEAS GUIDE

A practical system for getting paid, moving money, paying taxes, saving, and living well during an overseas season.

A field guide by Elijah Bryant.
Know your number. Protect your work. Build beyond basketball.

THE MONEY RULE

SALARY IS NOT THE SAME AS WEALTH.

Playing overseas can create a real financial opportunity. It can also make money feel confusing: a contract in one currency, expenses in another, taxes in two countries, fees between banks, and payments that do not always arrive exactly when expected. Your goal is not to become a financial expert overnight. Your goal is to build a simple system you can follow every month.

KNOW

Understand what you are owed, when it is due, and what should actually reach your account.

PROTECT

Keep records, maintain cash reserves, and respond quickly when something does not match the contract.

BUILD

Give every payment a purpose so a good season improves your life after the season ends.

DO NOT LET AN UNUSUAL INCOME CREATE ORDINARY FINANCIAL STRESS.

PERSONAL RULE: Keep the system simple enough to run after a road game, during travel, or when your family needs your attention.

Educational information only. This guide is not tax, legal, accounting, or investment advice. Rules vary by citizenship, residency, country, contract, and season. Work with qualified professionals who understand your specific situation.

SECTION 01

KNOW WHAT ACTUALLY HITS YOUR ACCOUNT.

NET SALARY

The contract states what should reach you after the agreed local taxes and deductions. Confirm what “net” includes and any exceptions.

GROSS SALARY

Taxes and deductions come out of the stated number. The headline salary can be much higher than your true take-home pay.

1 BEFORE YOU SIGN

- [ ] Write the total guaranteed salary, currency, payment count, and every due date in one place.
- [ ] Confirm whether salary, bonuses, housing, car, flights, and agent fees are net or gross.
- [ ] Ask who absorbs transfer fees and exchange-rate costs.
- [ ] Calculate the amount you expect to receive each month before making a budget.
- [ ] Keep a signed contract and every amendment saved offline and in secure cloud storage.

WRITE DOWN	EXAMPLE	WHY IT MATTERS
Contract amount	Net or gross	You cannot compare offers until you compare real take-home value.
Payment currency	USD / EUR / local	Your spending and savings can change when exchange rates move.
Due dates	Monthly schedule	A clear calendar shows a late payment immediately.

SECTION 02

BUILD A TWO-COUNTRY SYSTEM.

2 YOUR ACCOUNTS

- [ ] Keep a reliable home-country account open for long-term bills, savings, and life after the season.
- [ ] Open a local account only when it makes salary, rent, utilities, or daily spending easier.
- [ ] Confirm IBAN, SWIFT/BIC, routing details, beneficiary name, and address before the first payment.
- [ ] Test a small transfer before moving a large amount.
- [ ] Keep two cards from different networks and a small amount of emergency cash.
- [ ] Turn on transaction alerts and secure every financial account with strong two-factor authentication.

SPEND

Local account or card for rent, groceries, transportation, and normal life.

MOVE

A reputable transfer service or bank route with transparent fees and exchange rates.

PROTECT

Home account for reserves, taxes, savings, and obligations that continue while you are abroad.

BEFORE SENDING: Verify the recipient details through a trusted channel. Never change payment instructions only because an email or message tells you to.

SECTION 03

TRACK EVERY DOLLAR YOU ARE OWED.

TRACK	STATUS	RECORD
Salary payment	Due / received	Contract amount, due date, arrival date, currency, and amount received.
Bonus	Earned / pending	Trigger, evidence, approval, due date, and payment confirmation.
Reimbursement	Submitted / paid	Receipt, date submitted, person responsible, and amount.
Team-paid bill	Current / overdue	Rent, utilities, car, insurance, flights, or other promised benefits.

3 MONTHLY MONEY CHECK

- [ ] Match the bank deposit to the contract schedule.
- [ ] Record transfer fees and the exchange rate actually used.
- [ ] Save the payslip, bank confirmation, invoice, and relevant team messages.
- [ ] Update the amount still owed for salary, bonuses, and reimbursements.
- [ ] Move the planned amount to taxes, reserves, savings, and spending accounts.

IF YOU DO NOT TRACK IT, YOU ARE TRUSTING MEMORY DURING A LONG SEASON.

SECTION 04

GIVE EVERY PAYMENT A JOB.

LIVE

Food, transportation, family needs, travel, training, and a realistic amount of fun.

PROTECT

Taxes, emergency reserve, insurance gaps, medical needs, and late-payment buffer.

BUILD

Long-term savings, investing, debt reduction, education, business, and post-career goals.

4 BUDGET QUESTIONS

- [ ] What does the team pay directly, and what comes out of your pocket?
- [ ] What home-country bills continue during the season?
- [ ] How much cash would cover your family if one or two payments arrived late?
- [ ] What irregular costs are coming: flights, holidays, offseason housing, training, taxes, or agent fees?
- [ ] What amount will move toward long-term goals immediately after every payment?

FAMILY RULE: Agree on the season plan before the season gets busy. A shared number creates more peace than vague promises to “save more.”

YOU ARE ALLOWED TO ENJOY THE MONEY. JUST DECIDE WHAT MATTERS BEFORE THE MONEY ARRIVES.

SECTION 05

KEEP PROOF. ASK EARLY.

5 DOCUMENTS TO SAVE

- [ ] Signed contract, amendments, bonus agreements, and agent agreement.
- [ ] Payslips, bank statements, transfer confirmations, and exchange-rate records.
- [ ] Official local tax filings, payment receipts, certificates, and residency documents.
- [ ] Receipts for professional expenses your qualified adviser tells you to retain.
- [ ] Entry and exit dates for every country where you live, work, or spend substantial time.

ASK THE TEAM

Who files locally? When? What proof will you receive? Which taxes or social contributions were paid in your name?

ASK YOUR ADVISER

Where must you file? How does residency affect you? Could foreign tax credits, reporting, or estimated payments apply?

DO NOT WAIT: Find a professional who understands athletes and international income before the filing deadline is close. Give them organized records, not a season of screenshots.

Tax obligations can apply in more than one country and may depend on facts not covered here. Never rely on a teammate's result as proof that your situation will be treated the same way.

SECTION 06

STAY CALM. DOCUMENT EVERYTHING.

6 WHEN MONEY IS LATE

- [ ] Confirm the exact amount and due date in the signed contract.
- [ ] Check whether the transfer is pending, rejected, sent to incorrect details, or simply not initiated.
- [ ] Notify your agent in writing and keep the message factual.
- [ ] Ask for written confirmation, payment reference, and a specific resolution date.
- [ ] Follow the notice and cure procedure in your contract before taking formal action.
- [ ] Get qualified legal advice before refusing to practice, leaving, terminating, or posting publicly.

FIRST

Verify facts. A banking delay and a team refusing to pay are different problems.

NEXT

Create a written record with your agent, team contact, date, amount, and promised solution.

THEN

Use the contract process and qualified support. Emotion should not choose the remedy.

AN EMERGENCY FUND BUYS YOU TIME TO MAKE A SMART DECISION.

SCREENSHOT THIS

BEFORE THE SEASON ENDS.

- [ ] Every salary payment received
- [ ] Bonuses and reimbursements settled
- [ ] Local bills and deposits closed
- [ ] Tax proof requested and saved
- [ ] Agent fee reconciled
- [ ] Local bank closure plan confirmed
- [ ] Transfer limits checked before departure
- [ ] Emergency reserve replenished
- [ ] Offseason budget funded
- [ ] Records delivered to adviser

DO NOT JUDGE THE SEASON ONLY BY WHAT YOU EARNED. JUDGE IT BY WHAT YOU KEPT, LEARNED, AND BUILT.

A professional career can move fast. Teams change, countries change, currencies change, and your role can change. A simple financial system gives you something steady: you know what is owed, where your money goes, what your family needs, and what this season is building toward.

REVIEW TOGETHER: At the end of every season, sit down with your family and advisers. Keep what worked. Fix what created stress. Make the next contract easier to manage than the last one.

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